Essay Structure

Topic: Causes of Natural Disasters

Thesis Statement: Natural disasters are caused mainly by **natural geological a**nd c**limatic processes,** as well as **human activities** that can intensify their occurrence and severity.

Supporting Points/Plan of Development:
i) Geological causes
ii) **Climatic causes**
iii) Human activities

Topic sentence of the first supporting paragraph: Geological processes such as tectonic plate movements and volcanic activity are major causes of natural disasters.

Topic sentence of the second supporting paragraph: Extreme climatic conditions such as heavy rainfall, prolonged drought, and strong storms can also cause natural disasters.

Topic sentence of the third supporting paragraph: Human activities such as deforestation, unplanned urbanization, and environmental pollution can increase the risk and severity of natural disasters.

Concluding sentence: Thus, natural disasters are caused by a combination of powerful natural processes and human activities.

Causes of Natural Disasters

Natural disasters are sudden and destructive events that can occur in different parts of the world. Earthquakes, floods, cyclones, droughts, volcanic eruptions, and landslides are some common examples. Although these disasters are generally considered natural events, several factors can contribute to their occurrence. Natural disasters are caused mainly by **natural geological and climatic processes, as well as human activities** that can intensify their occurrence and severity.

One major cause of natural disasters is geological activity. The movement of tectonic plates beneath the Earth's surface can cause earthquakes. In some areas, volcanic activity can also lead to volcanic eruptions. Similarly, the movement of rocks and soil on steep slopes can result in landslides. These geological processes occur naturally and are often difficult to predict or prevent.

Another important cause is extreme climatic conditions. Heavy and continuous rainfall can cause rivers to overflow and result in floods. On the other hand, a long period without sufficient rainfall can cause droughts. Strong atmospheric and oceanic conditions can also create powerful cyclones and storms, particularly in coastal regions. Therefore, changes and extremes in weather and climate can contribute significantly to natural disasters.

Finally, human activities can increase the risk of certain natural disasters. Deforestation removes trees that help hold soil together and absorb rainwater, making areas more vulnerable to landslides and floods. Unplanned urbanization can block natural drainage systems and increase flooding. Human activities that contribute to climate change may also intensify some extreme weather events. Thus,

human interference with the environment can make some disasters more severe.

In conclusion, natural disasters have several causes. **Geological processes, extreme climatic conditions, and harmful human activities all contribute to the occurrence or severity of disasters**. Understanding these causes is important because better environmental practices and disaster preparedness can help reduce future risks.